D.J. PARIS

A PRICE CUT ISN'T YOUR STRONGEST MOVE RIGHT NOW.

There's a better one, and it costs the seller about the same.

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THE TYPICAL HOUSE PAYMENT JUST HIT $2,796 A MONTH. REDFIN HAS ONLY RECORDED ONE MONTH HIGHER THAN THAT, EVER.

Buyers aren't gone. They're priced out of the payment, not the house.

IT'S NOT A FLOOD OF HOUSES. IT'S THE PAYMENT THAT'S STUCK.

Redfin's own numbers, four weeks ending October 18: months of supply sits at 4.4, inside what Redfin itself calls a balanced market (4 to 5). Pending sales are down 14.4 percent year over year, the lowest level Redfin has on record, and more than one in five listings (21.7 percent) already carries a price drop. The payment, not the sticker price, just hit the second-highest number Redfin has ever recorded at $2,796 a month. A small price cut barely moves that monthly number. The same dollars put into a rate buydown move it every month the buyer owns the house.

WHAT TO BRING TO A STUCK LISTING THIS MONTH:

1 **Call your lender before you call the seller.**
Ask for the exact payment difference a one-point rate buydown creates on this specific house, at today's rate.

2 **Show the seller both numbers side by side.**
What a price cut saves the buyer, next to what the same dollars spent on a buydown saves them every single month.

3 **Put the buydown in the listing remarks.**
"Seller offering a rate buydown" reads differently to a buyer than another price reduction does.

4 **Ask for it on the buyer side too.**
If you represent the buyer, put the buydown credit in the offer instead of, or alongside, a price concession.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE LISTINGS SITTING THE LONGEST AREN'T PRICED WRONG. THEY'RE FINANCED WRONG.

Fix the payment this month, not just the price.

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